



Common English Verbs and Their Forms

The following are some of the most commonly used verbs in English along with their five main forms:

Root Verb	S Form	ING Form	Past Form	Past Participle
be	is	being	was/were	been
have	has	having	had	had
do	does	doing	did	done
go	goes	going	went	gone
come	comes	coming	came	come
get	gets	getting	got	got/gotten
make	makes	making	made	made
take	takes	taking	took	taken
give	gives	giving	gave	given
see	sees	seeing	saw	seen
know	knows	knowing	knew	known
think	thinks	thinking	thought	thought
say	says	saying	said	said
tell	tells	telling	told	told
speak	speaks	speaking	spoke	spoken
talk	talks	talking	talked	talked
hear	hears	hearing	heard	heard
listen	listens	listening	listened	listened
read	reads	reading	read	read
write	writes	writing	wrote	written
learn	learns	learning	learned/learnt	learned/learnt
study	studies	studying	studied	studied
teach	teaches	teaching	taught	taught
understand	understands	understanding	understood	understood
ask	asks	asking	asked	asked
answer	answers	answering	answered	answered

Root Verb	S Form	ING Form	Past Form	Past Participle
work	works	working	worked	worked
play	plays	playing	played	played
run	runs	running	ran	run
walk	walks	walking	walked	walked
sit	sits	sitting	sat	sat
stand	stands	standing	stood	stood
sleep	sleeps	sleeping	slept	slept
eat	eats	eating	ate	eaten
drink	drinks	drinking	drank	drunk
cook	cooks	cooking	cooked	cooked
buy	buys	buying	bought	bought
sell	sells	selling	sold	sold
pay	pays	paying	paid	paid
bring	brings	bringing	brought	brought
send	sends	sending	sent	sent
find	finds	finding	found	found
lose	loses	losing	lost	lost
win	wins	winning	won	won
meet	meets	meeting	met	met
keep	keeps	keeping	kept	kept
leave	leaves	leaving	left	left
open	opens	opening	opened	opened
close	closes	closing	closed	closed
drive	drives	driving	drove	driven
ride	rides	riding	rode	ridden
fly	flies	flying	flew	flown
swim	swims	swimming	swam	swum
begin	begins	beginning	began	begun
break	breaks	breaking	broke	broken
choose	chooses	choosing	chose	chosen

Root Verb	S Form	ING Form	Past Form	Past Participle
cut	cuts	cutting	cut	cut
draw	draws	drawing	drew	drawn
fall	falls	falling	fell	fallen
feel	feels	feeling	felt	felt
forget	forgets	forgetting	forgot	forgotten
grow	grows	growing	grew	grown
hold	holds	holding	held	held
lead	leads	leading	led	led
put	puts	putting	put	put
set	sets	setting	set	set
show	shows	showing	showed	shown
sing	sings	singing	sang	sung
spend	spends	spending	spent	spent
start	starts	starting	started	started
stop	stops	stopping	stopped	stopped
wear	wears	wearing	wore	worn



20 Essential Verbs Every Student Should Memorize

Root	S Form	ING	Past	Past Participle
go	goes	going	went	gone
come	comes	coming	came	come
eat	eats	eating	ate	eaten
drink	drinks	drinking	drank	drunk
write	writes	writing	wrote	written
read	reads	reading	read	read
speak	speaks	speaking	spoke	spoken
see	sees	seeing	saw	seen
take	takes	taking	took	taken
give	gives	giving	gave	given

Root	S Form	ING	Past	Past Participle
make	makes	making	made	made
do	does	doing	did	done
have	has	having	had	had
be	is	being	was/were	been
run	runs	running	ran	run
swim	swims	swimming	swam	swum
drive	drives	driving	drove	driven
buy	buys	buying	bought	bought
teach	teaches	teaching	taught	taught
learn	learns	learning	learned/learnt	learned/learnt

Practice Exercise

Please create five sentences using the same verb in different forms. Do it for at least 10 verbs.

Verb: Write

- I **write** neatly.
- He **writes** neatly.
- She is **writing** a letter.
- She **wrote** a letter yesterday.
- She has **written** a letter.

This will help you understand how verb forms change with tense and usage.